

Last Man Standing

Genre: Action Drama

Age Range: 18-25

Characters

MARCUS (24) - A determined young operative injured during a mission.

TYLER (22) - Marcus's loyal teammate and closest friend.

Difficulty: Intermediate

Scene Description

After a mission goes wrong, Marcus and Tyler find temporary shelter inside an abandoned warehouse. Marcus is badly injured and believes Tyler must leave him behind before enemy forces arrive. Tyler refuses.

TYLER: We need to move.

MARCUS: Then move.

TYLER: You're coming with me.

MARCUS: No, I'm not.

TYLER: Marcus—

MARCUS: Stop.

(Tyler kneels beside him.)

TYLER: I can get you up.

MARCUS: And then what?

TYLER: Then we keep moving.

MARCUS: On that leg?

TYLER: We'll figure it out.

MARCUS: That's not a plan.

TYLER: It's better than sitting here waiting to get caught.

MARCUS: You think I don't know that?

TYLER: Then help me out here.

MARCUS: I am helping you.

TYLER: By giving up?

MARCUS: By being realistic.

(Beat.)

TYLER: Realistic would have been turning around three miles ago.

MARCUS: Realistic would have been listening when I said it was a trap.

TYLER: That's not fair.

MARCUS: Fair?

(Marcus laughs painfully.)

MARCUS: We're being hunted through a warehouse district and you're worried about fair?

TYLER: I'm worried about you.

MARCUS: That's the problem.

TYLER: What does that mean?

MARCUS: It means you're thinking like my friend instead of my teammate.

TYLER: Maybe because you're both.

(Beat.)

MARCUS: Tyler...

TYLER: No.

MARCUS: You don't even know what I was going to say.

TYLER: I know exactly what you were going to say.

MARCUS: Then save us both some time.

TYLER: I'm not leaving.

MARCUS: You have to.

TYLER: No.

MARCUS: They aren't looking for both of us.

TYLER: That's not the point.

MARCUS: It is the point.

TYLER: No, the point is that we started this together.

MARCUS: And now one of us has a chance to get out.

TYLER: Then both of us are taking it.

MARCUS: You're being stubborn.

TYLER: I learned from the best.

(Marcus can't help smiling.)

MARCUS: That's a terrible argument.

TYLER: Still worked.

(A distant noise echoes outside.)

MARCUS: They're getting closer.

TYLER: I know.

MARCUS: Then why are you still here?

TYLER: Because if I leave, I'll spend the rest of my life wondering if I could have saved you.

MARCUS: You can't save everyone.

TYLER: Maybe not.

MARCUS: Then why try?

TYLER: Because nobody tried for me once.

(Beat.)

MARCUS: What?

TYLER: Before I met you.

MARCUS: Tyler—

TYLER: You pulled me out when nobody else would've.

MARCUS: That was different.

TYLER: No, it wasn't.

MARCUS: I didn't do anything special.

TYLER: It was special to me.

(Silence.)

MARCUS: You're making this really difficult.

TYLER: Good.

MARCUS: You know, for someone who talks this much, you're terrible at following orders.

TYLER: And you're terrible at quitting.

MARCUS: Who said I was quitting?

TYLER: You did.

MARCUS: No.

(Marcus struggles to stand.)

TYLER: Easy.

MARCUS: I said you should leave.

TYLER: That's basically the same thing.

MARCUS: Not anymore.

TYLER: What changed?

(Marcus finally gets to his feet.)

MARCUS: You did.

TYLER: That's the worst compliment I've ever received.

MARCUS: Get used to it.

(The distant sounds grow louder.)

TYLER: Can you walk?

MARCUS: Barely.

TYLER: Good enough.

MARCUS: That's your plan?

TYLER: Pretty much.

MARCUS: Terrible plan.

TYLER: Got a better one?

(Marcus thinks for a moment.)

MARCUS: Run toward the east exit.

TYLER: That's actually not bad.

MARCUS: I know.

TYLER: Ready?

(Marcus takes a breath.)

MARCUS: No.

TYLER: Same.

(Beat.)

MARCUS: Let's go anyway.

(Tyler helps him forward.)

BLACKOUT

Ending Beat:

Marcus stops seeing himself as a lost cause and chooses to keep fighting, while Tyler proves loyalty is stronger than fear.